Abiraterone and prednisolone: metastatic castration-resistant prostate cancer

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00103 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before starting

Full blood count, kidney and liver tests, glucose and blood pressure; electrocardiogram (ECG) if clinically indicated or if you have a cardiac history. Review potassium, swelling, heart health and all medicines.

STEP 2

Taking or receiving treatment

Take abiraterone on an empty stomach: at least 2 hours after food, then wait at least 1 hour before eating. Swallow tablets whole with water. Take prednisolone with food. If a daily dose of either medicine is missed, take the usual dose the next day; do not double it.

STEP 3

Tests and reviews

Blood count, kidney and liver tests, glucose and blood pressure every 2 weeks for the first 3 treatment months, then every 4 weeks. Potassium may need closer checks if low; assess swelling and cardiac symptoms. ECG if clinically indicated or with cardiac history.

STEP 4

Specific practical instructions

Never stop prednisolone suddenly or when abiraterone is held unless the team gives a steroid plan. Ask about a steroid alert card and illness instructions. Contact the team if vomiting prevents you keeping tablets down. Abiraterone with prednisolone must not be combined with radium-223.

STEP 5

Leaving with a clear plan

Confirm the next appointment, dose, support medicines and verified daytime and out-of-hours phone numbers.

Sources: NCCP 00103 v9: official regimen. Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.